Professional Writing

I. Resume

- It is a document that contains a brief account of a person's education, skills, work experience, and other qualifications.
- A resume's content will vary according to the purpose of the applicant and the nature of the job applied for. A standard resume should be well-written based on the following basic guidelines:

1. Contact information
   The first few details that your prospective employer will look for are your complete name, full current address, phone numbers, and email address. There is no need to include nicknames. Indicate only the number and/or email address that can be used to contact you directly.

2. Objectives
   One (1) to two (2) sentences long that describes the type of job you want, the type of organization you prefer and how you can contribute to the position/organization.

3. Education
   Includes college and high school information only. Do not forget to put the name of your school, degree, term of graduation, academic awards/recognition, or other awards sponsored by the school.

4. Work Experience
   This includes employer (name of organization), number of year/s employed, job title, and results and accomplishments on the job. For a stronger resume, avoid simply listing your responsibilities; quantify the results achieved.

5. Skills
   This includes the languages you speak and other special skills – e.g., typing, records filing, driving, etc. You may also include your computer/technical skills and level – e.g., MS Office - intermediate; MS Access – beginner; Visual Basic – beginner.

6. Extra-curricular Activities
   Includes the name of the organization, duration of participation, position, and results and accomplishments on the job. As much as possible, quantify results achieved. Participation in school contests and competitions is included in this portion.

7. References
   Include name/s, positions, organization, and contact number of person/s. For general resumes, it is acceptable to indicate "Available upon Request." If you must write your references, make sure to write it on a separate sheet of paper. Also, do not forget to inform your references that you have included them in your list.

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II. Sample Resume

Ariel T. Bayaborda
28-F Sunflower St., Golden Homes, Binondo Manila, 1006
963-84-54 / 0910-777-4444
bayaborda_a@yahoo.com

2" X 2" picture with white background

OBJECTIVE:
Dynamic professional poised to leverage education and experience toward launching a successful career as Financial Analyst. A team player committed to supporting San Jose Financial Corporation's objectives.

EDUCATION:

(Year Covered)	**STI College – Ortigas-Cainta**
2006 - 2010	Bachelor in Business Administration Award: Dean's Lister, 2006 - 2009
2002 - 2006	Francisco P. Felix memorial National High School High School Diploma Award: Best in Math, 2003 & 2006

WORK EXPERIENCE (if applicable):
Greenland Company – Quezon City, Philippines
2012 – 2013, Part-time Assistant Manager
- Participated in fiscal accounting and preparation of financial budgets and forecasts
- Obtained valuable hands-on business and finance experience in the real estate industry

SKILLS:
- **Financial Analyst:** Monitors and tracks trading details to understand market changes and plan professional investment strategies to maximize price benefits and minimize risk factors.
- **Communication and Presentation:** Exceptional interpersonal skill; Handles sensitive matters with tact, poise, and diplomacy; Communicates and interacts well with individuals at all levels.
- **Computers and Administration:** Proficiencies include Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, Access, Outlook, & PowerPoint), QuickBooks, Internet search, and applications.

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES:
Student Council, 2009-2010, President
- Drafted and implemented the "CLAY-GO" Policy in the campus cafeteria

REFERENCE:
Ronnie Flores
Manager for Training and Operations
Greenland Company, Quezon City
683-72-07

OJT COURSE POLICY
FT-APL-006-00 I STI Standard Resume Template I Page 1 of 1

III. Application Letter

- A document that provides additional information about a job applicant, it is also known as *cover letter*
- The parts of the letter are as follows:
  1. Introduction
     This part opens the letter and specifies the position that you are applying for.
     Here are some tips in writing an attention-grabbing introduction, along with some examples:
     a. Name the source of your information specifically.
        - Grace Chua, a staff member of your human resources division, has informed me that your company is looking for a marketing assistant.
        - Your advertisement in section C5 of the Philippine Daily inquirer for a computer technician interests me very much.
     b. State the job title and explain how your qualifications match its requirements.
        - Will a valedictorian of her high school batch and one year of part-time experience in tutoring grade school pupils qualify for your opening of a tutor in your review center?
  2. Body
     This part emphasizes your strongest points and shows how you meet the employer's needs. It is also essential to highlight the benefits that the organization will get from accepting you.
     You can also use this part of the letter to showcase your personality. Choose the best instances that reveal your ability to lead, work in a team, and communicate.
  3. Conclusion
     This part of the letter is where you request for an interview. Remember to sound enthusiastic and appreciative. And don't forget to include your contact information.
- There are three (3) possible formats that can be followed in writing an application letter: *block, indented,* and *modified block.* Each format consists of the same parts. Study the following examples.

A. Block Form

28-F Sunflower St., Golden Homes
Binondo, Manila, 1006
0910-777-4444 / 963845432
bayaborda_a@yahoo.com

September 11, 2016

Mr. Jasper Brian P. Lim
HR Manager
San Jose Financial Corporation
345 Sunville Avenue
Paco, Manila, 1007

Dear Mr. Lim,

I am writing to apply for the position, *Financial Analyst,* advertised in your company's website. I am a fresh graduate from *Manila College of Business* with a *Bachelor of Arts Degree in Business.*

The job opportunity posted in your company website is very interesting, and I believe that my educational background in finance and business, work experiences as a real-estate part-time assistant manager, and various technical skills make a very competitive candidate for the position. I have also a certificate in Financial Analysis, which I also acquired from Manila College of Business. I possess the key strengths that are necessary to grow and succeed as a Financial Analyst in your company. Aside from the degree programs that I have successfully pursued as a finance student in college, my professional experiences as a part-time assistant manager for GreenLand Company has helped me develop skills in financial and investment analysis, business management, research, and fiscal accounting. I am also an active contributing member of the Financial Management Association of the Philippines. Hence, I strongly believe that I can be a great asset to your company.

Kindly refer to my resume for more details about my skills and experiences. I look forward to discussing with you this employment opportunity. I am confident that working in your company will help me grow professionally, financially, and personally. You may reach me anytime through my email and phone numbers. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

ATBayaborda

Mr. Ariel T. Bayaborda

*Property of STI

B. Indented Form

28-F Sunflower St., Golden Homes
Binondo, Manila, 1006
0910-777-4444 / 963845432
bayaborda_a@yahoo.com

September 11, 2016

Mr. Jasper Brian P. Lim
HR Manager
San Jose Financial Corporation
345 Sunville Avenue
Paco, Manila, 1007

Dear Mr. Lim,

I am writing to apply for the position, *Financial Analyst,* advertised in your company's website. I am a fresh graduate from *Manila College of Business* with a *Bachelor of Arts Degree in Business.*

The job opportunity posted in your company website is very interesting, and I believe that my educational background in finance and business, work experiences as a real-estate part-time assistant manager, and various technical skills make a very competitive candidate for the position. I have also a certificate in Financial Analysis, which I also acquired from Manila College of Business. I possess the key strengths that are necessary to grow and succeed as a Financial Analyst in your company. Aside from the degree programs that I have successfully pursued as a finance student in college, my professional experiences as a part-time assistant manager for GreenLand Company has helped me develop skills in financial and investment analysis, business management, research, and fiscal accounting. I am also an active contributing member of the Financial Management Association of the Philippines. Hence, I strongly believe that I can be a great asset to your company.

Kindly refer to my resume for more details about my skills and experiences. I look forward to discussing with you this employment opportunity. I am confident that working in your company will help me grow professionally, financially, and personally. You may reach me anytime through my email and phone numbers. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

ATBayaborda
Mr. Ariel T. Bayaborda

*Property of STI

C. Modified Block Form

28-F Sunflower St., Golden Homes
Binondo, Manila, 1006
0910-777-4444 / 963845432
bayaborda_a@yahoo.com

September 11, 2016

Mr. Jasper Brian P. Lim
HR Manager
San Jose Financial Corporation
345 Sunville Avenue
Paco, Manila, 1007

Dear Mr. Lim,

I am writing to apply for the position, *Financial Analyst,* advertised in your company's website. I am a fresh graduate from *Manila College of Business* with a *Bachelor of Arts Degree in Business.*

The job opportunity posted in your company website is very interesting, and I believe that my educational background in finance and business, work experiences as a real-estate part-time assistant manager, and various technical skills make a very competitive candidate for the position. I have also a certificate in Financial Analysis, which I also acquired from Manila College of Business. I possess the key strengths that are necessary to grow and succeed as a Financial Analyst in your company. Aside from the degree programs that I have successfully pursued as a finance student in college, my professional experiences as a part-time assistant manager for GreenLand Company has helped me develop skills in financial and investment analysis, business management, research, and fiscal accounting. I am also an active contributing member of the Financial Management Association of the Philippines. Hence, I strongly believe that I can be a great asset to your company.

Kindly refer to my resume for more details about my skills and experiences. I look forward to discussing with you this employment opportunity. I am confident that working in your company will help me grow professionally, financially, and personally. You may reach me anytime through my email and phone numbers. Thank you for your time and consideration.

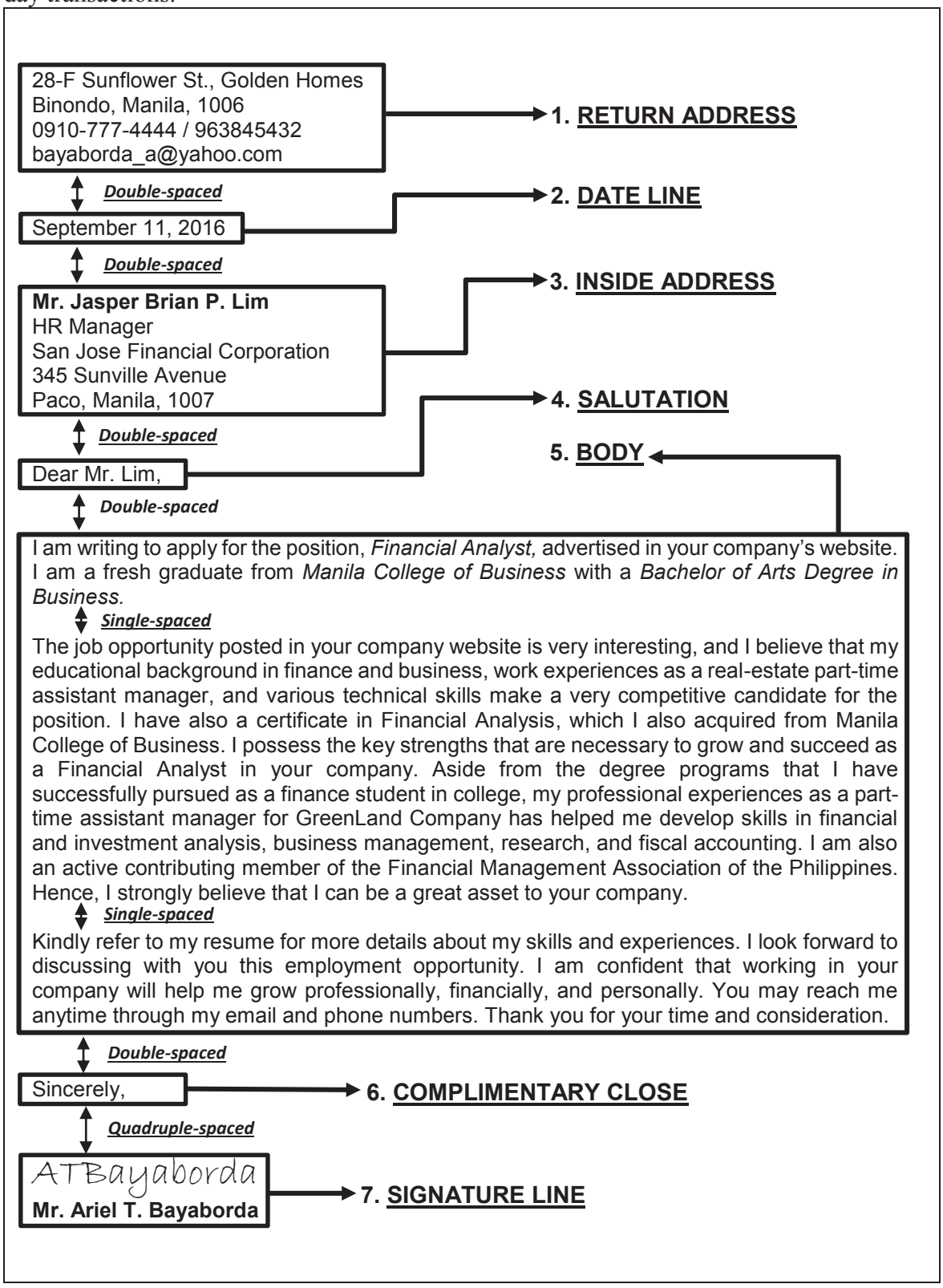
Sincerely,

ATBayaborda

Mr. Ariel T. Bayaborda

IV. Parts of a Business Letter

- A *business letter* is a formal type of written communication used by professionals in their day-to-day transactions.



A. Return Address

- The return address or *sender's address* usually is included in the letterhead. If you are not using letterhead, include the sender's address at the top of the letter one line above the date. Do not write the sender's name or title, as it is included in the letter's closing. Include only the street address, city, and zip code. You may also include the contact number and email address in this part.

B. Date Line

- The date line is used to indicate the date the letter was written. However, if your letter is completed over a number of days, use the date it was finished in the date line.

C. Inside Address

- The inside address is the recipient's address. It is always best to write to a specific individual at the firm to which you are writing. If you do not have the person's name, do some research by calling the company or speaking with employees from the company. Include a personal title such as Ms., Mrs., Mr., or Dr. Follow a woman's preference in being addressed as Miss, Mrs., or Ms. If you are unsure of a woman's preference in being addressed, use Ms.

D. Salutation

- Use the same name as the inside address, including the personal title. If you know the person and typically address them by their first name, it is acceptable to use only the first name in the salutation. In all other cases, however, use the personal title and last/family name.

E. Body

- It contains the message of the sender. In the first paragraph, consider a friendly opening and then a statement of the main point. The next paragraph should begin justifying the importance of the main point. In the next few paragraphs, continue justification with background information and supporting details. The closing paragraph should restate the purpose of the letter and, in some cases, request some type of action.

F. Complimentary Close

- The closing begins at the same vertical point as your date and one line after the last body paragraph. Capitalize the first word only and leave *four (4) lines* between the closing and the sender's name for a signature. If a colon follows the salutation, a comma should follow the closing; otherwise, there is no punctuation after the closing.

G. Signature Line

- This contains the signature and the full name of the sender. The sender can also put their title before their name to show how they wish to be addressed. For example, Miss, Ms., Mr., Mrs., Dr., etc.

V. Writing Office Correspondences

- Office correspondences normally take place between employees and employers. These are also written to communicate with clients and customers in a more professional manner.
- It is commonly known as *business letter.* It can be written using any of the three (3) standard formats: *block, indented,* or *modified block form.*
- The commonly used office correspondences are letters of *recommendation, acknowledgment, inquiry, request, complaint, apology,* and *resignation.* Business letters

consist of the same parts. However, the content varies based on the main purpose of the writer.

1. Recommendation
   Job applicants are usually required by their prospective employers to submit a letter of recommendation from their previous employer. The content of the letter focuses on the professional relationship between the applicant and the sender and the positive points that may convince the receiver to consider the ongoing application.

2. Acknowledgment
   It is also known as the letter of receipt. It is written to express acceptance or receipt of a prior correspondence. The sender usually lets the receiver know if an action regarding their request, complaint, or inquiry has already taken place.

3. Inquiry
   The letter of inquiry is written to ask a specific question or elicit an information from the addressee of the letter. In writing an inquiry letter, the sender should be specific with his/her question and identify exactly the list or kind of information needed.

4. Request
   Request letter is written to ask for a particular information, permission, favor, or service. Use of polite yet straightforward language should be properly observed when writing request letters.

5. Complaint
   Letters of complaint are written to express a problem, discontent, or protest about a particular situation. Complaint letters tend to have a strong content. However, the complainant should express his ideas and feelings in a more formal tone. Ruse or harsh language should never be used regardless of the nature of the complaint.

6. Apology
   It is written as an expression of regret and intention to make amends for a mistake or infraction committed. The sender should be able to explain the reason/s behind the mistake and provide a specific way to resolve the situation.

7. Resignation
   A resignation letter is written by an employee who wishes to formally leave his/her job position. The content includes the employee's reason/s for leaving and future career plans. The sender may also express his/her appreciation for the work experiences and career opportunities provided by the company/employer. It should also indicate the exact date the resignation will be effective.

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VI. Sample Business Letters

A. Letter of Request

Brentwood Language Center
36-F Molito Center, Alabang, Muntinlupa City
947-33-44 / 947-33-45
brentlanguagecenter@yahoo.com.ph

October 30, 2016

Mr. Kenneth B. Chan
General Manager
DreamStar Designs Inc.
567 Jones St. Cubao, Quezon City

Dear Mr. Chan,

I am writing to request a copy of your brochure, portfolio, and price list of web design services.

Our advertising department is currently on the process of creating a new interactive website for our company. We are interested in hiring your services to help us enhance our existing website.

Respectfully,

Erwin C Alfaro

Mr. Erwin C. Alfaro
Head, Advertising Department

B. Letter of Apology

DreamStar Designs Inc.
567 Jones St. Cubao, Quezon City
999-35-67 / 999-35-69
dreamstar@gmail.com

November 11, 2016

Mr. Alfaro,

I am writing to express my sincerest apologies for being unable to respond immediately to your request for a copy of our company brochure, portfolio, and price list of web design services.

Our company, with its newly appointed administration, has been experiencing a series of key staff changes for the past weeks, which have resulted in your letter of request being overlooked. Consequently, it took almost two weeks before your letter reached my office.

At DreamStar Design, Inc., we deeply value our professional relationship with you, our customers, and we take pride in ensuring our client's satisfaction with our services. However, we admit that this time we failed in meeting your expectations. Because of this, our Communications Department has already been directed to undertake certain measures to prevent communication system failures in the future.

I hope that you are still interested to avail out services. Attached herewith are the company brochure, portfolio, and price list of web designs that you have requested. Please do not hesitate to contact us should you have any questions or concerns about these documents.

Once again, I sincerely apologize for any inconvenience you may have experienced in respect to our failure to communicate with you promptly.

I hope for your kind consideration regarding this matter. Thank you for your understanding.

Respectfully,

K. Chan
General Manager
DreamStar Designs Inc.

C. Letter of Acknowledgment

Brentwood Language Center
36-F Molito Center, Alabang, Muntinlupa City
947-33-44 / 947-33-45
brentlanguagecenter@yahoo.com.ph

November 25, 2016

Mr. Kenneth B. Chan
General Manager
DreamStar Designs Inc.
567 Jones St. Cubao, Quezon City

Dear Mr. Chan,

Greetings!

I have received your letter of apology and I am glad to let you know that your apology has been gracefully accepted.

Our advertising department has carefully reviewed the brochure, portfolio, and price list that you sent us, and I am pleased to inform you that we have officially decided to avail your web design services.

Please contact us immediately so we can talk about the details.

Our team looks forward to working with you soon. Thank you.

Respectfully,

Erwin C. Alfaro

Mr. Erwin C. Alfaro
Head, Advertising Department

References:

Angeli, E & Allen Brizee. (n.d.). *Writing the Basic Business Letter.* Retrieved from https://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/653/01/

Bargo, D. (2014). *Writing in the Discipline.* Quezon City. Great Books Publishing.

Cidro, M. G. O., et al. (2016). *Integrated English for Effective Communication.* Quezon City. Phoenix Publishing House Inc.

Estacio, M. J. M. (2016). *Developing Reading and Writing Skills.* Quezon City. Phoenix Publishing House Inc.

Tiongson, M.T. & Rodriguez, M. R. C. (2016). *Reading and Writing Skills.* Manila. Rex Book Store. Inc.